

Demo day and your twelve-week plan

Week 10, Lecture 2 · Looksmaxxing: Evidence-Based Appearance Improvement

Autumn 2026

What we will cover

- How to present a before-and-after honestly and read your own data clearly
- The plan-on-a-page structure: eight pillars, twelve weeks, one page
- Habit retention science: Fogg Behavior Model and why small beats ambitious
- Quarterly review cadence: scheduling the check-in before you need it
- What the next twelve weeks look like and what the course cannot give you

Part 1: Reading your before-and-after honestly

What the data can and cannot tell you

- Ten weeks is enough time for skin to adapt to a new routine, for hair growth to respond to minoxidil, and for body composition to shift if training and nutrition were consistent
- Ten weeks is not enough time for androgenetic alopecia reversal to be visible, for orthodontic changes, or for significant recomposition from a starting point of low adherence
- The goal of the before-and-after presentation is accurate self-assessment, not marketing copy. A student who honestly names what stalled is more prepared for the next twelve weeks than one who overstates results.

Presenting the data: what to show

1. Side-by-side photos: week zero and week ten, same conditions
2. Tape measurements and weight trend if you tracked them
3. Pillar-by-pillar status: started / consistent / inconsistent / not started, for each of the eight pillars
4. Two verifiable changes: backed by a number, a photo, or a log
5. One thing that stalled, named honestly with a cause

The cause of what stalled matters more than the fact that it stalled. "I did not start tretinoin because my barrier was impaired and I could not get a prescription in time" is information. "I fell off" is not.

Common measurement errors to name

- Photos taken in different lighting or from different angles are not comparable. Acknowledge it.
- Weight without a trend line (7-day average) is noise. A single weigh-in proves nothing.
- “My skin looks better” without knowing whether you changed sun exposure, sleep, hydration, or skincare in the same period is not evidence of the skincare routine. Note confounders.
- None of these errors make the data useless. They make the interpretation more careful.

Part 2: The plan-on-a-page

Why one page

- A plan that takes three pages to read is a plan you will not review quarterly
- A plan-on-a-page forces prioritization: one habit per pillar, specific enough to be actionable, short enough to read in four minutes
- The format borrows from BJ Fogg's (2021) Tiny Habits framework: the goal is a behavior you can actually execute on your hardest week, not the behavior you wish you were executing on your best week

The eight pillars

The plan covers seven appearance pillars plus mental health:

Pillar	What one habit looks like
Skin	Sunscreen every morning before leaving
Hair	Minoxidil every night after brushing teeth
Body	Compound lifts 3x per week, progressive overload logged
Dental	Floss or interdental brush nightly, before brushing
Style	No new purchases for 90 days; wear the capsule only
Posture	Five-minute mobility routine on waking
Sleep	Lights off by 23:00, no screen in bed
Mental health	No looksmaxxing forums Mon-Fri

What makes a habit plan-ready

Fogg (2021): behavior occurs when motivation, ability, and a prompt converge. A habit in the plan needs all three.

- **Specific behavior:** not “do skincare” but “cleanse, apply tretinoin, moisturize: three products, in that order, after brushing teeth at night”
- **An existing anchor:** the new habit attaches to something you already do reliably. “After I [anchor], I will [new habit].”
- **A definition of done:** you know whether you did it. If you are unsure at 11pm, the definition is too vague.

Fogg: “Set the bar low, even two pushups, and keep it low. The emotion you feel right after the behavior is what wires the habit in, not repetition alone.”

The failure mode to avoid

- Setting an ambitious plan you maintain for two weeks, then abandoning when one disruption occurs
- The all-or-nothing failure cycle: one missed day becomes three, becomes “I fell off, I’ll restart Monday”
- Fogg’s fix: design the habit to survive your worst week, not your best. If you cannot do the minimum version on a sick day, the minimum is still too large.
- Missing once is an event. Missing twice in a row is a pattern. At two misses, reduce the habit to a smaller version rather than abandoning it.

Part 3: Quarterly review cadence

Why you need a scheduled review

- Without a review date, the twelve-week plan drifts silently. Habits that break get rationalized rather than corrected. Pillars that stall stay stalled.
- A quarterly review is the maintenance mechanism that keeps the plan alive between resets.
- Set the date before you leave this room. A calendar event three months from now takes 30 seconds to create and prevents the most common failure mode: forgetting to look at the plan until something is visibly wrong.

What a quarterly review covers

1. **Photo comparison.** Week zero to current, same conditions. This is why the baseline protocol matters past week ten.
2. **Pillar audit.** Which habits are running consistently, inconsistently, or not at all? One sentence each.
3. **What changed and why.** External factors (travel, illness, living situation), not character assessments.
4. **One adjustment.** Change one thing: tighten a habit, add one that is missing, drop one that is not serving its stated goal.
5. **Set the next review date.** Immediately. Before closing the document.

What the twelve-week horizon means

- Twelve weeks is one quarter. Most physical adaptation processes that respond to behavioral change operate on 6-12 week cycles: skin cell turnover, hair growth, strength adaptation, habit formation.
- A quarterly review cadence matches the biology. You are not checking monthly to see whether sunscreen worked. You are checking quarterly to see whether the system held.
- After four quarterly reviews (one year), you will have enough data to know which pillars respond fastest for you specifically, which require external support (a prescription, a training partner, a commitment device), and which habits were never going to stick in the form you designed.

Part 4: Wrapping the course

What the course gave you

- An evidence hierarchy for evaluating any appearance claim you will encounter after leaving
- Baseline measurement tools: photo protocol, tape measurements, trend-line weight
- Minimum-viable routines in each pillar, grounded in the evidence that actually exists
- A vocabulary for talking to dermatologists, barbers, trainers, and dentists
- One completed twelve-week plan that starts from week ten, not from scratch

What the course cannot give you

- Time. Skin barrier repair takes weeks. Hair loss reversal, if it happens, takes months. Recomposition takes a quarter. Nothing here is faster than the biology.
- Consistency. That is entirely yours. The course installed the habits; the habit machine runs whether you tend it or not.
- Immunity to forum culture or bad-photo days. Those will still occur. The Lecture 1 tools are for managing them, not preventing them.
- A finish line. There is no point at which appearance improvement is complete. The quarterly review is not a checkpoint on the way to done; it is a way of ensuring the investment stays proportionate to the return.

The long game, stated plainly

- The appearance gains in this course are real but front-loaded. The largest perceptible changes from sunscreen daily use, sleep improvement, and a basic skincare routine tend to accumulate in the first three to six months.
- Past six months, the changes are slower and subtler: reduced photoaging compared to a counterfactual, maintained muscle from consistent training, continued hair retention from minoxidil.
- The long game is not dramatic. It is a system that runs without daily decisions because the habits are anchored, the quarterly review is scheduled, and the goal is maintenance, not acceleration.

Habits are easier to form than most people think if you do it the right way. Set the bar low, even two pushups, and keep it low. The emotion you feel right after the behavior is what wires the habit in, not repetition alone.

<footer>BJ Fogg PhD, Stanford Behavior Design Lab. Build Good Habits, Episode 107, 2021.
</footer>

Take-aways

1. An honest before-and-after names what changed and what stalled, both with evidence. Overstating results leaves you without useful information for the next twelve weeks.
2. The plan-on-a-page has one habit per pillar, each with a specific anchor and a definition of done. If it cannot survive your hardest week, reduce it until it can.
3. Fogg's Behavior Model: behavior requires motivation, ability, and a prompt converging at the same moment. Redesign around the prompt first, not the motivation.
4. A quarterly review is a calendar event, not an intention. Set the date before you close this document.
5. The course ends. The system does not have to.

What's next

- **Section (today):** Present your before-and-after and your twelve-week plan to two peers. Group debrief.
- **Capstone (due today):** Personal twelve-week plan and before-and-after presentation submitted as your course deliverable.
- **After the course:** Your quarterly review date is on your calendar. Your plan-on-a-page is in a place you will find it. That is all you need to keep going.